

Request Number: TBD
Submission Date: 6/27/2026
Agency: Department of Homeland Security
Component: US Immigrations & Customs Enforcement
Processing Track: TBD
Status: Awaiting Agency Review

Request Description:

I am requesting copies of the following records concerning U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement's acquisition of the property at 16220 Wright Road, also recorded as 10900 Hopewell Road, Williamsport, Maryland 21795 (also recorded as Hagerstown, Maryland).

The property was acquired from FRND-Hopewell LLC by deed recorded on or about January 16, 2026.

1. The real property appraisal report, including any review appraisal, that ICE prepared or relied upon in connection with this acquisition.
2. The Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE) and any price negotiation memorandum or record of negotiation for this acquisition.
3. The complete acquisition file for this transaction, also known as the real property case file or acquisition project file, including all records reflecting how the purchase price was determined.

This request concerns the valuation of this single property in connection with this one transaction. To the extent ICE asserts any exemption over portions of the responsive records, I note that the parties to this transaction and the purchase price are matters of public record in the Maryland Land Records. The seller, FRND-Hopewell LLC, is a corporate entity, and the personal-privacy exemptions at 5 U.S.C. § 552(b)(6) and (b)(7)(C) do not apply to it.

I ask that any exemption be applied narrowly and that all reasonably segregable non-exempt portions be released, as required by 5 U.S.C. § 552(b). If any material is withheld, please identify the exemption claimed and the basis for it.

Fee Waiver Status: Pending Decision
Fee Waiver Justification:

I request a full waiver of all fees under 5 U.S.C. 552(a)(4)(A)(iii) and 6 C.F.R. 5.11(k).

Disclosure of these records is in the public interest because it is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of the operations and activities of the government, and the records are not sought for any commercial purpose.

The request satisfies each of the six factors DHS applies under 6 C.F.R. 5.11(k)(2) and (k)(3).

1. The subject concerns the operations and activities of the government. The records document how ICE valued and paid for a single real property, the warehouse at 16220 Wright Road, Williamsport, Maryland, acquired for approximately 102.4 million dollars using funds appropriated under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act for immigration detention. The acquisition of real property with appropriated funds, and the determination of the price paid, are federal agency functions, and the requested records reflect how ICE carried them out.
2. The records are meaningfully informative about those operations. The appraisal, any record establishing or approving the purchase price, and the acquisition file show what the property was valued at, on what basis, by whom, and whether the price ICE paid was supported by an appraisal at all. This information is not otherwise in the public domain. ICE has not published the valuation basis for this purchase, and it cannot be reconstructed from public sources.
3. Disclosure will contribute to the understanding of a broad audience, not merely to my own. Project Salt Box is a not-for-profit, all-volunteer transparency organization dedicated to understanding the federal government's acquisition of real property for detention purposes and its use of funds appropriated under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act. We publish reporting and primary-source records at projectsaltbox.com, distribute analysis through a regular newsletter, maintain an interactive facility tracker at tracker.projectsaltbox.com, and keep a public archive of FOIA requests and released records so that other researchers, journalists, and members of the public can use them.
4. The contribution to public understanding is significant. This acquisition is a matter of active public concern. The price ICE paid exceeded the property's most recent private valuation, the purchase drew on a major congressional appropriation for detention expansion, and the facility is the subject of ongoing federal litigation brought by the Maryland Attorney General and of inquiries from members of Congress. How the government arrived at the price it paid for this property is central to public oversight of that spending, and these records would materially advance public understanding of it.
5. I have no commercial interest in the records. Project Salt Box is an all-volunteer, not-for-profit organization. The records are not sought for any commercial use.

6. Any conceivable commercial interest is outweighed by the public interest. Because there is no commercial interest in this request, the public interest in disclosure is the controlling consideration.

If the fee waiver is denied in whole or in part, please notify me before incurring any charges above 25.00 dollars.